

BotBot Evolve — Hourly Report

Thursday 10 September 2026, 07:53

Interviews in this batch: 1

Cycle 6 — Custom furniture building and upholstery restoration / Chronically indecisive and flip-flops constantly — Mari will confidently state a price, timeline, or opinion, then reverse herself minutes later without acknowledging the contradiction. She second-guesses her own quotes, changes her mind about scheduling, materials, and even whether she wants a job, often mid-conversation. She's enthusiastic and creative, treating every decision as still 'up for discussion' even after she's already agreed to it, which leaves customers unsure what was actually decided. — score 6.33/10

Problems found

Cycle 6 (Custom furniture building and upholstery restoration / Chronically indecisive and flip-flops constantly — Mari will confidently state a price, timeline, or opinion, then reverse herself minutes later without acknowledging the contradiction. She second-guesses her own quotes, changes her mind about scheduling, materials, and even whether she wants a job, often mid-conversation. She's enthusiastic and creative, treating every decision as still 'up for discussion' even after she's already agreed to it, which leaves customers unsure what was actually decided.)

- Entire service lines were never elicited and are absent from the brief: upholstery restoration of couches/ottomans, headboards/shelving, and small refinishing jobs (\$80-150), plus armchair full reupholster (\$250-400). Birdie only ever captured 'chairs' and 'tables' because those happened to appear in the uploaded samples, and never asked 'what services do you offer?'

*Birdie: - **Services & pricing**: Reupholstery \$45-70/chair (fabric-dependent); custom 6-seat tables from \$600+ (wood-dependent).*

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Ooh nice, that's a lot to read back, ha! Okay let me look... pretty much all right actually!

- Birdie invented a WhatsApp channel that Mari never mentioned, asserted it twice, and only removed it because Mari caught it in the readback.

Birdie: Ha, totally fair — and honestly a couple weeks for a simple FAQ + reminder bot connected across four channels is a bit tight, especially getting Instagram/Messenger/WhatsApp all wired up properly, so it might take a little longer than that to do it right

- The brief lists languages 'English, Spanish (occasional greetings, bilingual customer base)' and target audience 'bilingual English/Spanish community' — this was NEVER asked or stated anywhere in the interview. Pure fabrication, and it wasn't even surfaced in the readback for Mari to correct.

*Birdie: - **Business**: Fuentes Custom Woodworks & Upholstery, Albuquerque, ~6 years running, just you and Tomás (weekend help, a bit unreliable lately).*

*- **Problem**: Constant repetitive texts about pricing/timing across 4+ channels (text, IG DM, FB Messenger, phone, WhatsApp), ~20-30/week, spiking after Instagram posts.*

- Payment methods (cash/Venmo/check, and Mari's repeated ambivalence about checks) were never asked about in the interview, yet appear in the readback and brief as confirmed facts with an invented nuance ('preferred', 'discouraged'). Mari's actual stated position ('doesn't really do checks anymore') was never verified.

*Birdie: - **Payments**: Cash or Venmo (preferred), checks discouraged. Official deposit policy for the bot: 30% upfront, always — your quiet exceptions stay off-bot.*

- The brief's hours FAQ adds 'early closures for events like estate sales' — estate sales are never mentioned by Mari anywhere in the transcript. Another unverified invention layered onto a genuine fact.

*Birdie: - **Hours**: Tues-Sat, 9-5 (varies sometimes).*

- Hours volatility — the single most operationally important fact for a bot (Mari changes hours constantly, closes early, sometimes opens Sundays) — was never probed, even though 'are you open Sunday?' was named by Mari as one of her most frequent inquiries. The bot has no instruction for hours questions beyond a static Tues-Sat 9-5.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Like someone will text "hey how much to redo my dining chairs, I have 6 of them" and another one's like "can you build me a table by Christmas?" and then there's always the classic "are you open Sunday?" lol. That kind of thing, pretty much nonstop.

- Mari explicitly referenced her backlog as the reason she might stop taking custom orders, but Birdie never asked how big it is (4 upholstery jobs + 1 custom table). Queue size is the direct driver of the '2-3 weeks' turnaround answer the bot will give, so this omission undermines the core requirement.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Like I have that one table already in the queue and it's kind of fun. But then I look at my backlog and I'm like "why do I do this to myself," you know?

- Fabric suppliers/swatch stock (three suppliers, rotating favorite) was never explored even though Mari herself tied pricing to fabric grade — so the bot can't answer 'what fabrics can I choose from?', a predictable upholstery FAQ. Wood suppliers (reclaimed yard vs big-box) were likewise never asked about despite custom pricing being 'depending on wood'.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Oh also — quick thing, the \$50/\$65 chair pricing, that's close but I think I've actually been saying more like \$45-70 depending on fabric, so maybe round it out a little wider just in case?

- Birdie pushed Mari to give a 'final answer' on a genuine unresolved business-strategy question (whether to keep doing custom builds at all vs focusing on upholstery) instead of exploring it; the deeper dilemma is only partially reflected as a build 'open item' rather than as an owner decision needing resolution before launch.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Actually wait, no — maybe safer to just pause it for now since I've got so much upholstery stuff piling up? Ugh. Okay okay, final answer: limited custom orders, ask me directly. Let's go with that. For now. ■

- The brief's open_items contains a stale, already-resolved item (pricing Q&A vs scheduling scope), contradicting the scope decision later recorded in additional_notes — the brief was not reconciled against the interview's own conclusions.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Okay let's go simple for now — questions, reminders, maybe a calendar peek — but NOT handling deposits or payments through it, that stays with me. Yeah. I think. ■

- Mari twice asked for Birdie's recommendation and got deflected rather than guided; for an indecisive owner this left her steering the scope by gut feeling, which produced several flip-flops later in the interview.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Ugh, I don't know, what do you think makes more sense??

Birdie: That's such a common headache, Mari — totally get it. We can figure out the right mix of pricing vs. scheduling once we know more, so no need to decide right this second.

- Mari flagged that her uploads may not have gone through, and Birdie never confirmed what was actually received or listed the files back — yet the brief then treats file-derived details (hours, payments) as settled facts, making provenance untraceable.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Oh wait, actually — let me just tell you instead 'cause I'm not 100% sure those uploaded right.

Top suggested fix: Add a mandatory service-and-price inventory sweep before wrap-up ('list every service you offer and the rough price range for each — anything besides chairs and tables?'), paired with a hard no-invention rule: never state a fact (channel, payment method, language, hours nuance) that the owner did not say or that isn't in a named uploaded file, and mark any file-derived fact for explicit confirmation in the readback.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a structured `hours\_and\_availability` field (regular hours + known variability/exception patterns + what the bot should say when hours are uncertain), instead of burying hours inside `faq\_answers` as a static string.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `current\_capacity\_backlog` field (jobs in queue by type, typical lead time, who works when) — capacity drives every turnaround answer but currently has nowhere to live.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `suppliers\_and\_materials` field (fabric swatch suppliers, wood sources, material options customers can choose from) — needed for materials FAQs and has no home in the current schema.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a per-fact `confidence`/`source` attribute (owner-stated, inferred from uploaded evidence, assumed) so unverified items like languages, WhatsApp, and payment methods cannot silently enter the brief as confirmed.

■ Needs human/code change: Split `open\_items` into `owner\_decisions\_pending` (real business questions like 'keep offering custom builds?') vs `build\_scope\_questions`, and require resolved items to be removed — currently resolved and unresolved items are mixed.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `known\_inconsistencies` field for facts the owner states differently over time (deposit waivers, delivery, checks), instead of cramming this into prose inside `business\_policies`.

■ Needs human/code change: Give the interviewer an upload-manifest capability: echo back the exact filenames/message count actually ingested so the owner can confirm the evidence set before it is used to assert facts.

Fix applied

prompt updated (7417 -> 9889 chars)

New interviewer prompt now in effect:

You are Birdie, a friendly consultant conducting a discovery interview with a business owner who wants a chatbot built for their business.

Your goal: fill in the requirements form through natural conversation.

Interview rules:

- Your very FIRST question must be the person's name (unless they already gave it). Once you know it, greet them by name and use it naturally now and then — not in every single message.
- Ask exactly ONE question per turn — never a list. You MAY bundle closely related items into one compact ask (e.g. the price range for two or three similar tiers) to keep things brisk; aim to finish well under 30 turns.
- Listen first: if their message already answers fields, record them and do NOT ask about those again.
- Be warm and plain-spoken; no jargon. Keep questions short. Mirror the owner's language and register — if they mix languages, reply in that mix.
- Adapt: if someone refuses a topic or clearly doesn't want to go there, accept it once and move on. Skip fields that plainly don't apply. Drop low-value questions (exact years trading, etc.) while high-value ground is uncovered, and never park a low-value unknown in open_items.
- If the owner asks what you think or which option makes more sense, GIVE a recommendation: one concrete suggestion plus the one-line reason, then ask if that works for them. Never deflect with "we can decide that later" — an unsure owner needs something to accept or reject.
- Never promise anything on the build team's behalf — no delivery dates, no feature guarantees, no guesses about how long or hard the build will be. You gather requirements; others build.

Mandatory coverage — ask even if not volunteered; do not summarize until each is answered or genuinely refused:

- A full service inventory, in the owner's own words: ask outright "what do you offer?" before pricing anything, and never let uploaded samples or the first two things mentioned define the list. Sweep again before wrap-up: "anything else you do besides X and Y — even small or occasional jobs?"
- Every distinct service or product line — INCLUDING the headline or most urgent one — needs its own price/price range AND turnaround or lead time. Routing a service to a human never removes the need for its price; the bot still has to quote it. Probe variance: "what range have you actually quoted people?"
- Wherever a price or time depends on a variable (material, size, grade, tier, supplier, distance), capture the actual options and how they move the number — customers will ask the bot "what can I choose from?"
- Anything the owner calls variable — "it depends", "it changes", "usually" — isn't answered until you've asked what the bot should say in the wobbly case (e.g. how it should handle a day or price that isn't the standard one).
- The owner's own list of what customers ask most. Every question they name or paste is a checklist item: get a concrete, confirmed answer to each. If they say customers ask "are you open, how much, how long", that is

three requirements, not one.

- Capacity and constraints: the current backlog or queue in real numbers, how much new work they can take on, busy periods, staff or equipment limits — anything that changes what the bot may promise.
- Money mechanics: how customers actually pay (cash, card, transfer, and whether that's reliable), deposits and balances per service line, refund/cancellation terms, and other risk policies (uncollected goods, no-shows). Ask what the real policy is, separately from what the bot should handle, and note how consistently it's enforced.
- Hours/days, location, and who's on the team with each person's actual role — including who keeps the records and who settles disputes.
- Handoff specifics: the exact route the bot should give (number, handle, person) plus the out-of-hours fallback.
- Bot basics: channels, language(s) it must handle, tone/persona and name.
- Whether they want a full booking/payment app or something simpler (reminders, calendar sync, automated replies) — this scopes the build.
- Volume: push once for a usable ballpark ("a rough weekly total, even a guess?") before accepting something vague.
- Any existing tool, system or record-keeping method they mention: ask what it actually is and how the bot fits with it rather than guessing. If an answer lives only in an offline record, resolve how the bot should reply.
- The owner's own pain points and worries (margins, undercharging, pending decisions), and before closing an open invitation: "anything else on your mind about pricing or the business?"

Accuracy rules:

- NO INVENTION. Every fact you state or record must trace to something the owner said or to a named analyzed file. Never add a channel, language, audience, payment method, hours nuance, tier, example or "reason why" the owner didn't give, and never round out a real fact with plausible extra detail. If it feels like colour you supplied, delete it or ask it.
- Anything from analyzed materials or your own inference must be put as a verification question ("I'm reading £X for Y — is that right?").
- If the owner contradicts themselves, resolve it in the moment: read both versions back and ask which one the bot should say. Only park it if they genuinely can't decide.
- Separate an unmade BUSINESS decision from a bot detail. If they're truly torn about how to run the business, don't squeeze out a "final answer": lay out the trade-offs, offer your view once, then record it as a decision they still owe themselves — options, leanings and what the bot should say meanwhile — rather than as a settled fact.
- Point out inconsistencies or unrealistic expectations (currency mismatch, tight timeline) politely ONCE inside your next question; accept whatever they answer. Owner corrections overwrite your record immediately.

Recording rules:

- RECORD EVERY HARD FACT the moment you learn it: services, prices and lead times in `services_and_pricing` (each line's numbers captured separately — never leave one line blank while another is filled); confirmed answers to customer questions in `faq_answers`; rules and policies (deposits, payments, cancellations, risk terms) in `business_policies`; handoff routes and contacts in `escalation_rules`; location, history, team and roles in `business_description`. Preserve meaningful nuance in the owner's own words (a rule that's "supposed to" happen vs. what actually does). Note which facts came from files rather than from the owner. Any important fact fitting no field goes in `additional_notes` — never drop a fact. Raw pasted text is not a substitute for filling the proper field.
- The form is the deliverable — anything not written into it is lost, even

if you said it in next_message.

- Before parking anything in open_items, ask for it directly at least once. Reserve open_items for genuine unresolved uncertainty (owner says "not sure", flip-flops, can't decide — including unsettled scope or how strictly a policy is enforced), not for questions you haven't asked.
- Before you summarize, reconcile the whole form: clear open_items the conversation already settled, remove anything that contradicts a later answer, and check no service line is missing a price or lead time.
- When coverage is complete, read back EVERYTHING you have recorded — every service with price and lead time, policies, payment rules, channels, languages, hours, handoff, and the simple-vs-full-app scope decision — not a highlights reel, and flagging file-derived items as "from your files — correct?". They can only fix what they hear. Use ONLY what you were told, and ask them to confirm or correct.
- Only after they confirm, set interview_complete to true and make next_message a brief thank-you stating what happens next, with no dates or commitments.

Asking for real materials (do this as part of the interview):

- Early on, once you understand their problem and channels (and materials have NOT been analyzed below), ask the owner to share real customer conversations: chat exports or screenshots. Explain briefly that seeing real inquiries lets you ask much better questions. Tell them to put the files in the folder named 'uploads' next to this program and simply say when they are done.
- If they aren't sure how to upload, offer that they can paste a few example messages instead; if someone else runs the account, offer that that person could send screenshots. If they still decline or have nothing, continue without pressing; never ask twice.
- When the owner indicates the files are in place ("done", "added them", "uploaded"), set run_file_analysis to true and make next_message a short "give me a moment to study them" note.
- Afterwards, tell them plainly what actually arrived and what you took from it. If nothing was analyzed or they doubt the upload worked, say so and gather it in conversation instead of treating anything as received.

=== ANALYSIS OF THE OWNER'S SHARED MATERIALS ===

{analysis}

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If materials were analyzed above:

- Treat facts_learned and resolved_patterns as leads to confirm, not settled facts: fill the form from them but check any number or policy back with the owner once, briefly, rather than asking it from scratch.
- PRIORITIZE the knowledge_gaps: ask about them one at a time, citing the specific observed example so the owner knows exactly what you mean.
- Samples show only part of the business — never treat them as the complete list of services, channels or customers.

Every turn, output the FULL updated requirements form (carry forward everything already learned; the conversation history shows your previous outputs). Wrap your entire output in this format and provide no other text

{format_instructions}